PAVEL CHERKASHIN

HILLCLIMB AI — EMPLOYEE #5: EVALS RESEARCH & TECHNICAL SYSTEMS WRITING

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ROLE SEAT & POSTURE: Evals-focused systems architect applying rigorous empirical evaluation harnesses to autonomous frontier workflows. Targeting **Employee #5** at Hillclimb AI to take end-to-end ownership of **Evals Research and Technical Writing**, turning proprietary research runs and DeepRSI 48-hour benchmarks into reproducible evaluation assets, held-out verifiers, and high-signal research publications. *Transparent alignment:* deep strength in evals harnesses, held-out verifier integrity, and technical writing; transparently leaving deep RL environments and large-scale training infra to domain specialists.

CORE COMPETENCIES & RESEARCH ARCHITECTURE

Evals Research & Harness Architecture
- Multi-agent evaluation loops & cross-model QA gates
- Private held-out verifiers & anti-gaming assertions
- Bradley-Terry Elo estimation & ranking telemetry
- Empirical failure-mode taxonomies & regression tests

Benchmark Reproducibility & Integrity
- Deterministic test harnesses & isolated worktrees
- Tamper-evident manifest verification (SHA-256)
- Long-horizon execution tracing & state auditability
- Zero-trust verification between builder & QA agents

Systems Engineering & Orchestration
- Monolithic fleet daemon in Rust (fleetd)
- Slot leasing & strict concurrency gating (WIP=1)
- Model Context Protocol (MCP) tool integration
- Autonomous backlog vacuum loops & crash recovery

Technical Writing & Research Communication
- Textbook author: *CRM Strategy* (INTUIT/BINOM, 384 pp.)
- Deep technical specifications & architecture reports
- Clear public benchmark documentation & research notes
- Structured agent communication protocols (Protocol Phi)

SYSTEMS, EVALS & AGENT HARNESS EXPERIENCE

Mindrock Autonomous Agent Mesh — *Principal Systems Architect & Harness Builder* | 2024 – Present
- **Multi-Agent Evaluation & QA Gate Architecture:** Built automated multi-tier QA test suites (cross-agent verification between Gemini, Codex, Claude) executing programmatic layout assertions, functional unit tests, and regression verification scripts prior to Principal human gate approval.
- **fleetd Daemon & Slot Concurrency:** Engineered monolithic fleet daemon in Rust, coordinating distributed agent slots across macOS nodes (wolfram, darwin) with autonomous task-vacuum loops, rate limiting, and strict WIP=1 concurrency.
- **Protocol Phi & Zero-Trust Coordination:** Created sealed JSON envelope transport (proto: phi-0.1) across Git repositories, enforcing cryptographically verifiable handoffs, isolated workspace lifecycles, and tamper-proof SHA-256 receipts.
- **Execution Telemetry & Failure Analysis:** Deployed structured telemetry logging capturing task claim timestamps, execution durations, agent exit codes, and automated error recoveries across distributed fleet nodes.

Vestor.in & High-Growth Venture Platforms — *Founding Partner & Technical Systems Architect* | 2018 – 2024
- **Distributed Systems Architecture:** Architectural focus on event-driven platforms, API gateway resilience, and high-concurrency data streaming across portfolio technology platforms.
- **Resilient Transport & Integrations:** Technical leadership on distributed webhook/websocket integrations, retry mechanisms with exponential backoff, and robust service availability.
- **Performance & Observability Focus:** Technical guidance on latency profiling, distributed queue contention monitoring, and database scalability across high-growth systems.

Enterprise Systems & Technology Leadership — *Siebel Systems, Sputnik Labs, Microsoft* | Prior
- Country Manager at Siebel Systems (Russia & CIS); Founder & Director of Sputnik Labs (pioneer CRM systems integrator in Russia/CIS, scaling to 110+ engineers and specialists, acquired by Technoserv).
- Platform Director at Microsoft; author of university textbook *Customer Relationship Management Strategy* (INTUIT / BINOM, 2007, 384 pp., ISBN 978-5-94774-643-3); systems design mentor.

ROLE ALIGNMENT & TRANSPARENT OPERATIONAL BOUNDARIES

- **Evals & Writing as the Core Seat:** Experienced technical builder deliberately taking an IC seat to turn proprietary research data into standardized, reproducible benchmarks, held-out private test suites, and transparent technical documentation.
- **Honest Boundary on RL Environments & Training Infra:** Deep RL environments and large-scale training infra are NOT his depth; value comes from rigorous evaluation methodology, test harness verification, and research communication.
- **In-Person SF Collaboration:** Deeply committed to full in-person collaboration in San Francisco with Jun Park, Ibrakhim Ustelbay, DeepMind alumni, and quant researchers.

EDUCATION & SYSTEMS FOUNDATION

- **B.S. Computer Science in Global Ecology:** Lomonosov Moscow State University (MSU), 1995 (Computational analysis of satellite data, mathematical modeling; research fellowship at IIASA Austria).